

M11 SUBSTANCE USE SERVICES | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Increase availability and access to substance abuse and addiction support services, resources and care and prevent the development of substance abuse and addiction among occupants.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to outline policies regarding drug and alcohol use in the workplace, provide education on substance use and addiction and support access to substance use services.

Issue : Alcohol and drug use contribute significantly to the global burden of premature death and disability.¹ Harmful use of alcohol is a leading global risk factor, accounting for 3.3 million deaths per year (or 5.9% of all deaths) and 5.1% of the global burden of disease in 2014.² Within the workplace, alcohol use is a significant risk factor for absenteeism, presenteeism, accidents and employee turnover.^{3,4} It is also estimated that approximately half of the overall social costs of alcohol are due to lost productivity.⁵ In addition to alcohol, illicit drug use remains a serious global public health concern: in 2013, 246 million people between 15 and 64 years of age used illicit drugs, of which one in ten suffered from a drug use disorder or dependency.⁵

Solutions : Prevention programs that address substance use through education and workplace policy, as well as available and affordable screening and treatment offerings, have been shown to be effective methods of preventing unhealthy substance use habits and supporting those struggling with substance abuse and addiction.^{3,4,6} The return on investment in offering substance use treatment and prevention services is known. For example, each \$1 invested in screening and brief counseling interventions saves approximately \$4 in health care costs.⁷ Offering prevention, education and support services provides an opportunity to reduce the costs companies face as a result of undiagnosed and untreated substance abuse.⁷

PART 1 OFFER SUBSTANCE USE EDUCATION (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

1: Substance use policy and education

The following requirements are met:

- a. A policy is in place regarding the use of alcohol, legal and recreational drugs on-site and is clearly communicated to all regular occupants.⁷
- b. Trainings (in the form of education seminars, workshops or classes) are offered at least once per year to regular occupants and addresses the following topics:
 1. Management of personal substance use, covering, at minimum, safe substance use habits, signs of dependency or addiction and short- and long-term health risks associated with substance misuse or addiction.^{8,9 2.}
 2. Prescription opioid education, covering, at minimum, questions to ask at point of prescribing, safe use (e.g., storage, disposal, driving while using) and risks and signs of dependency or addiction.^{9 3}
 3. How to appropriately respond to a peer struggling with substance use, covering, at minimum, how to support a peer's recovery efforts and what to do in the case of relapse or a substance use emergency (e.g., withdrawal, overdose).⁸
- c. Training is provided in-person or virtually; in group or individual settings; through vendors, on-site staff, health insurance plans or programs, community groups or other qualified practitioners or programs (e.g., Mental Health First Aid).¹⁰

PART 2 PROVIDE SUBSTANCE USE AND ADDICTION SERVICES (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The following requirements are met for all eligible employees:

- a. Substance use and addiction services are available at no cost or subsidized and include at a minimum:
 1. Clinical screening and referral to licensed mental health professionals and support resources.⁷
 2. Counseling services, including telemental health services (e.g., online behavioral therapy).⁷
 3. Outpatient treatment (e.g., day programs).⁷
 4. Inpatient treatment (e.g., residential programs, hospitalization).⁷
 5. Medication-assisted treatment (e.g., methadone treatment).⁷
- b. Organizational commitment to mental health parity in health service coverage.⁸
- c. Information on benefits coverage and how to access substance use and addiction services and community resources (e.g., peer support groups, online support groups) is easily and confidentially available (e.g., via a health portal or employee website).^{7,8}
- d. Confidential benefits consultation is available with clearly identified and qualified support staff (e.g., benefits counselor, human resources representative).

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